

Teaching Statement

Teaching Philosophy

My teaching philosophy is centered on the idea of supporting students' ability to formulate questions, make sense of available information, evaluate opportunities, and make informed judgements. This is the essence of being a critical thinker, in my view. As a student of risk management and insurance (RMI) myself since being an undergraduate, I believe RMI is a great context in which to achieve critical thinking and is part of the reason I have continued to make RMI an intellectual home for myself. The philosophy is bigger than any one subject – it is about pushing students to think critically about whatever we are discussing, whether it is workers' compensation, microinsurance, defined benefit pension plans, or captive arrangements. Each of those topics provides a laboratory to develop critical thinking, focusing less on memorizing and more on problems, data, and solutions. In practice, I believe students are set up best to do this when they get opportunities to speak about, play with, and apply the material.

To bring the concepts to life, I use examples from current issues to encourage students to think about how the “stuff” they see, such as the headlines on the front page of the *Wall Street Journal*, can be viewed through an RMI lens. As instructor of record this summer for the introductory Risk Management course, I employed an exercise I termed ‘on-calls’ in class. These ‘on-calls’ allowed students to describe ideas they had been writing about in weekly discussion boards (which asked them to connect course content to news headlines) and to share, through elaboration, with their fellow students. Most importantly, this gave students a chance to practice talking through content. Throughout the past seven years as a teaching assistant (TA), I have encouraged students to use their own examples. It provides an opportunity for them to speak, teach their colleagues, and receive live feedback on the way they apply course concepts, which offers the entire class a chance to engage and practice, even if they only listen.

While students desperately want a single “right” answer and to be told what it is, I believe that our students perform better in the long run when encouraged to develop a process of evaluation and to defend the answer they obtain. To encourage students' ability within an RMI context, I offer an outline of each class period, which includes definitions and formulas. Students need to add their own comments, listen and participate in the discussion, and formulate their own answers and the “why” part for questions asked.

This method of limited reliance on slides and greater emphasis on handouts developed while I gave visiting lectures to the full introductory RMI class during my time as a TA. Given my undergraduate experience, research interests, and professional certification as a Certified Employee Benefits Specialist (CEBS), a niche area of my teaching expertise is in employee benefits. This expertise led me to offer a lecture on human capital risk each semester for the last several years. Employee benefit topics provide a place to offer students life-relevant content (i.e., an understanding of health plan options) and an application of current issues (i.e., underfunding of defined benefit pension plans), and I leaned into that when designing and giving the lecture. The combination of the topic with my philosophy meant a set of slides mostly focused on

graphics and figures, with handouts that allowed for less focus on copying notes and more focus on engaging with content.

With this practice of content engagement among students, I also prefer most of my office hours to be open, where students can join as they please and content is discussed as a group. This gives some students a chance to explain to their colleagues – good practice for exams – and offers other students a chance to hear the delivery of content in a new way. My philosophy inspires me to encourage students to engage with the content in the small group office hour settings, to the benefit of everyone involved, and to take that idea to their studying outside of office hours as well.

I also have come to thoroughly enjoy another part of the teaching process representing the ultimate application of the material: connecting students with industry contacts for internship and full-time job opportunities. One of the benefits of an undergraduate RMI degree from Temple University and a PhD from the University of Wisconsin-Madison (UW-Madison) is the large network of professionals with which I stay connected. These connections are not only useful for me in adding new topics into my conversations with students, but they also provide a direct point of entry for students into the profession. Numerous times so far at UW-Madison I have spent time with students outside of the classroom discussing professional opportunities, especially in employee benefits roles. Each time, I connect them with a person in a role of interest and work to get them a Zoom meeting. These meetings are quite impactful for students, who either go on to apply for positions in those companies or leave the meeting with a better understanding of where they may fit. I have also continued to be a mentor for Temple's Gamma Iota Sigma chapter in their formal mentorship program. This approach to the professional development of RMI students is something I look forward to continuing to contribute to the strong foundation of the University of Georgia's (UGA) RMI program.

Teaching Experience

As a PhD student at UW-Madison, I have been involved with our introductory RMI course, Principles of Risk Management, as a lecturer (during the summer 2025 term), and – for four years – as a TA. As a TA, I worked with two professors, Joan Schmit and Carl Barlett, in both in-person and virtual mediums. I attended lectures, held weekly office hours, gave a lecture each semester myself (as described above), assisted in writing and grading exams, led the development of content for weekly TA sections, and actively recruited students to the major. Each semester, I led three or four weekly TA sections, which included me designing in-class exercises (with group work and then discussion among the class), writing quizzes, discussing homework assignments, and leading reviews of exams. Over the course of my four years, I led 26 TA sections for 762 students, of which 477 submitted a teaching evaluation. In the end, my overall teaching evaluation score was 4.77 out of 5, which averages over all semesters and weights each section's score by its number of respondents. Based on my average evaluation scores and response rates, I have been awarded a Distinguished Teaching Award from the Wisconsin School of Business (WSB) four times, one for each year of my TA work. More details on my course evaluation scores can be found in the *Addendum* on pages 4 and 5.

Of course, teaching does not happen only in the formal classroom with students. I have experience being involved with the training for new TAs at WSB and also at the orientation for new PhD students. In addition, I have taken on a leadership role within the department and the larger business school community in planning research events. Two years ago, I led the organization of informal research meetings for the department's PhD students, which sometimes involved research workshop sessions with faculty present and other times involved discussion of research ideas as a student group. Last year, I was the organizer for the more formal risk and insurance research workshop. I also organized the inaugural WSB Summer Research Workshop, which aligned faculty discussants with doctoral student presenters from different departments across the business school for a day-long conference. These efforts are a realization of my teaching philosophy, even in the research domain, by connecting research across silos of specialization and, therefore, making research more digestible and applicable to business.

Teaching Opportunities

My experience equips me well to teach the introductory RMI course, which I have taken, taught myself, been a peer teacher for, or worked with more formally as a TA at two top RMI programs each year for the last seven years. My undergraduate coursework, along with my research interests and pertinent graduate coursework, also equips me to teach other classes in UGA's RMI major. I have reviewed the major's course requirements online and feel as though I could teach whatever the department needs. Given my areas of research interest, I would happily consider adding to special topics courses and potential new offerings in employee benefits management, retirement plans, insurance and public policy, and selection issues in insurance markets. My graduate training in an RMI program also equips me to add value in graduate seminars. As an undergraduate, I had the great fortune of working with Martin Grace and Cameron Ellis in an independent study situation; I would be eager to participate in a similar design at UGA if the opportunity presented itself.

Addendum: Teaching Evaluation Scores (sorted most to least recent)

A. As Instructor of Record (full file of evaluation form responses attached below, with student comments in the final three pages)

Course Number, Name, and Semester	Evaluation
RMI 300, Principles of Risk Management, Summer 2025	<i>Average score; response rate; number of students</i>
<i>Instructor of Record (Lecturer)</i>	4.91/5; 86%; 14

B. As Teaching Assistant

Course Number, Name, and Semester	Class Section	Evaluation	Professor
RMI 300, Principles of Risk Management, Spring 2024		<i>Average score; response rate; number of students</i>	Carl Barlett
<i>Teaching Assistant</i>	DIS 304	4.89/5; 77%; 13	
	DIS 305	4.89/5; 66%; 29	
	DIS 306	4.84/5; 88%; 17	
RMI 300, Principles of Risk Management, Fall 2023		<i>Average score; response rate; number of students</i>	
<i>Teaching Assistant</i>	DIS 305	4.75/5; 76%; 17	
	DIS 306	4.62/5; 73%; 30	
	DIS 307	4.69/5; 76%; 21	
RMI 300, Principles of Risk Management, Spring 2023		<i>Average score; response rate; number of students</i>	Carl Barlett
<i>Teaching Assistant</i>	DIS 301	4.73/5; 60%; 43	
	DIS 302	4.79/5; 82%; 38	
	DIS 303	4.9/5; 83%; 30	

RMI 300, Principles of Risk Management, Fall 2022		<i>Average score; response rate; number of students</i>	Joan Schmit
<i>Teaching Assistant</i>	DIS 305	4.85/5; 79%; 14	
	DIS 306	4.8/5; 71%; 21	
	DIS 307	4.92/5; 100%; 11	
RMI 300, Principles of Risk Management, Spring 2022		<i>Average score; response rate; number of students</i>	Carl Barlett
<i>Teaching Assistant</i>	DIS 304	4.86/5; 100%; 11	
	DIS 305	4.69/5; 68%; 34	
	DIS 306	4.91/5; 56%; 16	
RMI 300, Principles of Risk Management, Fall 2021		<i>Average score; response rate; number of students</i>	
<i>Teaching Assistant</i>	DIS 301	4.69/5; 71%; 42	
	DIS 302	4.66/5; 67%; 43	
	DIS 303	4.57/5; 74%; 35	
RMI 300, Principles of Risk Management, Spring 2021		<i>Average score; response rate; number of students</i>	Joan Schmit
<i>Teaching Assistant</i>	DIS 301	4.86/5; 43%; 40	
	DIS 302	4.83/5; 48%; 46	
	DIS 303	4.7/5; 45%; 42	
	DIS 304	4.74/5; 57%; 21	
RMI 300, Principles of Risk Management, Fall 2020		<i>Average score; response rate; number of students</i>	
<i>Teaching Assistant</i>	DIS 301	4.8/5; 45%; 42	
	DIS 302	4.81/5; 47%; 43	
	DIS 303	4.72/5; 33%; 40	
	DIS 304	4.79/5; 57%; 23	

GEN BUS ACCT FIN INTL BUS MHR MKT OTM RMI
081025 **Completed**

📅 2025 Summer / Student Course Evaluation (End of Term) / Anonymous Survey

Course Assignments: **27** / Survey Participants: **886**

Schedule: 8/3/2025 to 8/10/2025

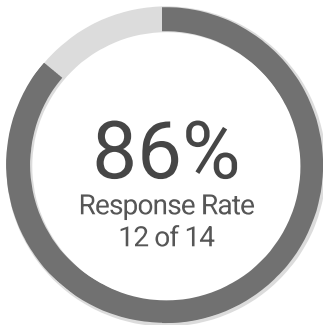
Results Available: 8/14/2025



This survey completed on **Sunday, August 10, 2025 at 11:59PM.**

Institution: University of Wisconsin Madison
College: Business
Department: Risk and Insurance
Course Section: R M I 300 001 Principles of Risk Management
Course Section Director: 👤 NA
Instructor: 👤 Tyler Welch

📊 Survey Overview : Course Section Results Aggregate



TOTAL SURVEYS

14



SURVEYS COMPLETED

12



PENDING SURVEYS

2



COURSE ASSIGNMENTS

1

📊 Survey Metrics : Course Section Results Aggregate

Average Rating for Course Section



This is the average of the instructor multi-choice questions one through ten.

Avg (Average)	Min	Max	#Resp (Number of Responses)	Target	Success
4.91	3	5	120	NA	NA

Survey Data : Course Section Results Aggregate

SET Survey Questions

1

Course requirements were clear to me.

(Instructor Multi-Choice)



Average Rating for Course Section



Tyler, Welch Instructor

Value	Option	Total
1	Strongly disagree	0
2	Disagree	0
3	Neither Agree or Disagree	0
4	Somewhat agree	0
5	Strongly agree	12
-	Does not apply	0

Average

5.00

Median

5.00

Mode

5

Std. Dev. (Standard
Deviation)

0.00

Variance

0.00

*

2

Course organization (syllabus, course website, pace/schedule) supported my learning.

(Instructor Multi-Choice)

 Tyler, Welch Instructor

Value	Option	Total
1	Strongly disagree	0
2	Disagree	0
3	Neither Agree or Disagree	0
4	Somewhat agree	1
5	Strongly agree	11
-	Does not apply	0

Average
4.92
Median
5.00
Mode
5
Std. Dev. (Standard Deviation)
0.28
Variance
0.08

*

3

Course materials (textbook, readings, media, cases, software, etc.) supported my learning.

(Instructor Multi-Choice)

 Tyler, Welch Instructor

Value	Option	Total
1	Strongly disagree	0
2	Disagree	0
3	Neither Agree or Disagree	1
4	Somewhat agree	2
5	Strongly agree	9
-	Does not apply	0

Average
4.67
Median
5.00
Mode
5
Std. Dev. (Standard Deviation)
0.62
Variance
0.39

*

4

Course content (lectures, assignments/learning activities, discussions, peer engagement, etc.) supported my learning.

(Instructor Multi-Choice)



Average Rating for Course Section



Tyler, Welch Instructor

Value	Option	Total
1	Strongly disagree	0
2	Disagree	0
3	Neither Agree or Disagree	0
4	Somewhat agree	0
5	Strongly agree	12
-	Does not apply	0

Average
5.00
Median
5.00
Mode
5
Std. Dev. (Standard Deviation)
0.00
Variance
0.00

*

5

The instructor actively engaged me in learning throughout this course.

(Instructor Multi-Choice)



Average Rating for Course Section



Tyler, Welch Instructor

Value	Option	Total
1	Strongly disagree	0
2	Disagree	0
3	Neither Agree or Disagree	0
4	Somewhat agree	2
5	Strongly agree	10
-	Does not apply	0

Average
4.83
Median
5.00
Mode
5
Std. Dev. (Standard Deviation)
0.37
Variance
0.14

*

6

The instructor provided a welcoming environment in which to learn.

(Instructor Multi-Choice)



Average Rating for Course Section



Tyler, Welch Instructor

Value	Option	Total
1	Strongly disagree	0
2	Disagree	0
3	Neither Agree or Disagree	0
4	Somewhat agree	0
5	Strongly agree	12
-	Does not apply	0

Average

5.00

Median

5.00

Mode

5

Std. Dev. (Standard
Deviation)

0.00

Variance

0.00

*

7

The instructor's teaching methods were effective for my learning.

(Instructor Multi-Choice)



Average Rating for Course Section



Tyler, Welch Instructor

Value	Option	Total
1	Strongly disagree	0
2	Disagree	0
3	Neither Agree or Disagree	0
4	Somewhat agree	1
5	Strongly agree	11

Value Option	Total
- Does not apply	0

Average
4.92
Median
5.00
Mode
5
Std. Dev. (Standard Deviation)
0.28
Variance
0.08

*

8

The instructor showed concern for me and my learning.

(Instructor Multi-Choice)

 Average Rating for Course Section

 Tyler, Welch Instructor

Value Option	Total
1 Strongly disagree	0
2 Disagree	0
3 Neither Agree or Disagree	0
4 Somewhat agree	0
5 Strongly agree	12
- Does not apply	0

Average
5.00
Median
5.00
Mode
5
Std. Dev. (Standard Deviation)
0.00
Variance
0.00

*

9

The instructor was accessible for questions, discussion, support, etc.

(Instructor Multi-Choice)



Average Rating for Course Section



Tyler, Welch Instructor

Value	Option	Total
1	Strongly disagree	0
2	Disagree	0
3	Neither Agree or Disagree	0
4	Somewhat agree	1
5	Strongly agree	11
-	Does not apply	0

Average
4.92
Median
5.00
Mode
5
Std. Dev. (Standard Deviation)
0.28
Variance
0.08

*

10

The instructor provided feedback on my work (assignments/learning activities, exams/quizzes, etc.) that was useful to my learning.

(Instructor Multi-Choice)



Average Rating for Course Section



Tyler, Welch Instructor

Value	Option	Total
1	Strongly disagree	0
2	Disagree	0
3	Neither Agree or Disagree	0
4	Somewhat agree	2
5	Strongly agree	10
-	Does not apply	0

Average

4.83

Median

5.00

Mode

5

Std. Dev. (Standard
Deviation)

0.37

Variance

0.14

*

11

Overall, where would you place this **instructor** compared to your other university **instructors**?

(Instructor Multi-Choice)



Tyler, Welch Instructor

Value	Option	Total
1	Bottom 10%	0
2	Next 20%	0
3	Middle 40%	0
4	Next 20%	3
5	Top 10%	9

Average
4.75
Median
5.00
Mode
5
Std. Dev. (Standard Deviation)
0.43
Variance
0.19

*

12

Please provide comments related to this **instructor**: What was done well? How could the **instructor** improve?

(Instructor Text/Memo)



Tyler, Welch Instructor

- Enjoyed working with Tyler this summer! Super nice and excited about the content, which made the content more interesting to learn! Very good at explaining concepts and helped with multiple questions!
- Tyler honestly did an amazing job and deserves to be in the top 10% category. He was enthusiastic about the learning and encouraged others to be as well by interacting with current news stories and world events that could be tied back to risk management. He was always accessible for questions and understanding and accommodating about deadlines and schedules.
- Tyler is extremely knowledgeable on insurance and risk and provided so many opportunities for help, questions, and one on one meetings regarding quizzes and exams. He was always excited to teach which made me very excited to learn. I honestly can't think of anything he could improve and am ending this class feeling like I have learned a lot.
- I felt the lectures were very engaging and easy to follow. I also really liked that the instructor gave out handouts for us to follow, that is always very helpful.
- Very fun and involved with getting students engaged
- The instructor did well providing us with examples that properly illustrated the content - though I feel for some of the definitions, there were some that were not previously loaded.
- I think the professor's understanding and willingness to help is unmatched to any professors. He has made a class I did not think I would find interesting, to be interesting. He has got a great happy spirit and really makes a summer class I did not want to take enjoyable. I love when he has little blurbs on ramdom things, like Diet Pepsi. Would recommend highly. He always helped out when it came to my busy schedule and was flexible if I was on a time-crunch. Big thanks to you professor Welch. - Ryan
- Tyler was great in engaging the class and providing different contexts for course topics, which helped me retain the course information much better in the short amount of time we had. He was easy to contact and to meet with, which was very helpful when receiving feedback and asking questions. I was worried about covering the course in fewer weeks, but Tyler used graded material as a way to kind of push me to study, which really helped especially in motivation. His explanations were also always very clear; when I came up with an answer for something, his content review would always support and add on to what I thought I already knew.

- Nothing
- Amazing.

excited understanding risk honestly learn summer tyler
 made really **always** helped
 has help greatengaging easy follow content

13

Overall, where would you place this **course** compared to your other university **courses**?

(Multi-Choice, Single Answer)

Value	Option	Total
1	Bottom 10%	1
2	Next 20%	0
3	Middle 40%	1
4	Next 20%	7
5	Top 10%	3

Average

3.92

Median

4.00

Mode

4

Std. Dev. (Standard
Deviation)

1.04

Variance

1.08

*

Please provide comments related to this **course**: What was done well? How could the **course** be improved?

(Text/Memo)

- Course was well organized, I liked how the hw and in class exercises were not graded, yet we still went over them for understanding, that helped a lot!
- N/A
- I know this is a summer course so it might not be possible, however I'm someone who has a hard time focusing for long periods of time. Honestly even breaking up lectures to even 1:30 hours would probably help me a lot, even at the expense of having one more lecture a week. I also really liked how we go over questions and answers in class and the explanations for them. It's a really contrast to some of my other courses right now where I'm very unsure if I have concepts correct or not.
- Everything good
- I loved the teaching style and content was interesting and challenging, but not overwhelmingly challenging. Perfect class for the summer.
- This course does a great job covering all benefits and potential drawbacks of risk and insurance and applying them to real-world situations
- I felt that the course was structured very clearly, with course content that builds up on itself and supports further understanding of previous unit content. It felt useful not only for learning about business operation and how firms mitigate risks, but also about how insurance works for a personal context, especially since I wasn't aware of many of the things learned in this course.
- Availability from Tyler was amazing as well as his flexibility during a summer term with everyone having things going on. The structure of in class exercises and homework directly correlated to the class as well.

having time summer understanding exercises liked
really
challenging
insurance
felt
things

course

i'm content
class